

Pull out a tablet – any tablet – in front of any of the somewhat ‘tech savvy’ middle aged uncles and aunties you know, and instantly the first question is “Oh wow, is that an iPad?”. We can’t really blame them. The last time iPads had any real competition was with the Nexus tablets back in 2013 and that too only because of the huge price differential. Till today iPads dominate the tablet space for a variety of reasons, which we will discuss later in the chapter.

For now here’s a fun fact you may not know: Apple actually developed the iPad long before the iPhone. They wanted a touchscreen computer with an onscreen keyboard that was all self contained and thus, the first prototype of the iPad was born. But they shelved the project because they thought that a phone would work much better with this idea and many many years later, the iPhone was born in 2007. Then they finally revived the tablet computer project and the first iPad was released in 2010. There has been at least one new iPad launch every year since then, and the eventual diversification of the device into four different distinct lines viz. the iPad, the iPad Mini, the iPad Air and the iPad Pro, each having different strengths and tradeoffs. Here’s a quick rundown on the timeline of each line and the different models within it.

A brief history of everything iPad

The iPad - The OG series

It’s the basic idea of a tablet, albeit one that’s built really well. If you’d allow some programming humor, this line is the class from which every other iPad is a mere instance. All regular iPads have a 9.7 inch display and are fairly chunky. They are mostly aimed at home use – for people to casually browse the web, watch videos and FaceTime. For a lack of a better term, just to do iPad things. This is also our favorite iPad product line so we are going to take extra pains to explain its greatness to you. So young padawan, iPad models five, there were.

- **2010** - The first ever iPad, this one basically is the granddaddy of all the different models out today. It had a resolution of 1024x768, with a pixel density of 132 ppi. While this is pretty much one fourth of the display specs we see on modern devices today, at that time, this was groundbreaking. It also boasted an A4 single core chip and a whopping 10 hour battery life. Hardware specs aside, it also had a major advantage over all the Android tablets out there at the time – iOS actually had more apps than Android and therefore, you could theoretically do more with an iPad